



Google smart AR glasses

Google is making plans for the Metaverse with a pair of smart AR glasses.
<https://dgit.in/jan22-19>



5G technology rollout

5G telecom services to be rolled out in selected cities across India in 2022.
<https://dgit.in/jan22-20>

PlayGo N37

Well-built entry-level wireless earphones

World of Play is an audio company that has a fairly decent portfolio of affordable audio products. The company's latest wireless earphones offering is the PlayGo N37 – a sporty, affordable neckband-style wireless pair of earphones with some alluring features such as IPX5 water resistance rating and USB Type-C charging. Let's see if these earphones are worth considering.

BUILD AND COMFORT

The highlight of the PlayGo N37's build is what the company calls a "Premium, Ultra-Flexible Design". We first expected this statement to be an exaggerated gimmicky statement but upon handling the earphones for the first time, we were pleasantly surprised. The neckband really is one of the softest and most flexible ones we've felt and it even feels surprisingly premium for a neckband pair of earphones under 3K. The material feels smooth and comfortable on the skin and contours to the exact shape of your neck.

The earphones house a toggleable power button, volume + and volume - buttons that double as controls for switching tracks and a multifunction button. You have a USB Type-C charging port tucked under a flap.

The earbuds have an angled nozzle that further enhances the fit and there are also silicone wings available over the silicone ear tips that ensure a snug fit in most ears. We found the earphones extremely comfortable and secure to wear, even over extended periods of time.

FEATURES

These earphones aren't as feature-laden as competitors such as the Realme Buds Wireless 2 and the Mi Bluetooth Earphones Pro. The former even comes with app support, customisable controls, and more! You won't find all that here, so we did dock a lot of



points in the features section.

However, the PlayGo N37 does come with some enticing features that make it a moderately decent deal at under 3K. You get Bluetooth v5.0 connectivity with 33 feet or 10m of wireless range. Additionally, you also get voice assistant support n.

There's also IPX5 water resistance so you can easily use these earphones when running or working out.

PERFORMANCE

Equipped with 10mm EBEL (Extra Bass, Extra Loud) drivers, the PlayGo N37 performs true to its driver's name. These earphones are extra loud and do have extra emphasised bass response. So, if that's what you're about, you won't be disappointed. These earbuds only support the SBC codec and not AAC, which is usually common at this price point. As for the sound signature, as we mentioned earlier, these earphones are bass-boosted. So, right from the low bass region of the frequency response curve to the high bass region, the bass is heavily boosted making for boomy, dark bass response that masks the clarity of the rest of the frequency range. The mids and highs suffer from serious auditory masking, especially

the highs post 2kHz since they are already under-represented.

So, this sound signature works acceptably with genres such as pop, rap, EDM, and Bollywood, but the earphones don't work for genres that have a lot of nuance and detail in the high-mids and highs such as rock and classical. For example, in the track Pull Me Under by Dream Theatre, the cymbals and hi-hats sound listless and lack detail, partly due to the underemphasis of the highs and partly due to the overbearing bass response.

As for the microphone, the earphones pick up the caller's sound and relay it audibly but the output can sound slightly distorted at times.

The battery life of these earphones is rated at 10 hours by the company. In our tests, at

60 percent volume, we got about 9 hours and 15 minutes of wireless playback time which is pretty close to the company estimate.

VERDICT

Priced at ₹2,999, the

PlayGo N37 has some things to like and some, not so much. We were impressed with the build and comfort of these earphones – especially the super-flexible neckband and the secure fit of the buds. What we didn't like was the lack of AAC codec support and the overemphasised bass response that mars the overall sound quality of the earbuds due to auditory masking in the mids and highs. So, the earbuds struggle to stand out amongst competitors such as the Realme Buds Wireless 2 and the Mi Bluetooth Earphones Pro.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

DIMENSION (HXWXL MM): 26*12.8*130mm | WEIGHT: 26g | CABLE LENGTH: 250mm | BATTERY: 100mAh | CONNECTIVITY: Bluetooth 5.0 | OPERATING RANGE: Upto 10 Meters | CONNECTION: USB & Aux | PLAYTIME: Upto 10 Hours | STANDBY TIME: 120 Hours | CHARGING TIME: Approx 40 Minutes | IN-LINE REMOTE: Yes

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